

The Plan, On One Page

THE PROBLEM

Analysts manually copy every customer email into SNYPR, and every SNYPR alert into email.

There is no ticket of record. SLAs are tracked by memory. Responses get lost.

Halo was supposed to fix this. It didn't.

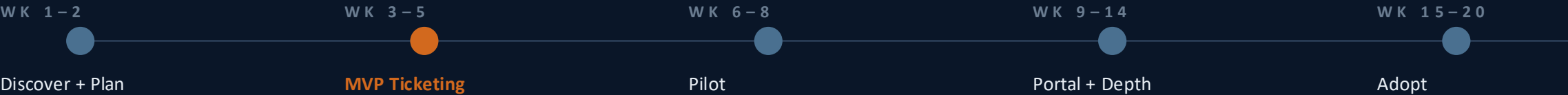
RECOMMENDATION

Build the ticketing system Jim asked for. Nothing more.

A SNYPR-to-ticket bridge, an email-to-ticket bridge, and a simple customer portal. Eight weeks.

No CRM. No quoting. No project management. Halo's mistakes, avoided on purpose.

THE ROADMAP



THE NUMBERS

8 WEEKS	committed build	~150	VDA customers served	12	SOC analysts daily
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Building VDA's Ticketing Layer

A focused 8-week MVP to replace manual email + SNYPR copy-paste — and the foundation for the customer portal and client reporting that follow.

FIRST CUSTOMER COMM SENT FROM THE TOOL

WEEK 5

PREPARED FOR KENDALL · VDA LABS LEADERSHIP

Why This Plan Exists

Jim and Sibe told us what they actually need, and it's narrower than what most vendors pitch.

Today, the SOC team copies every customer email into Securonix SNYPR by hand. Every alert that needs to be communicated gets copy-pasted into a new email. Responses come back to soc@vda1abs.com and have to be manually re-associated with the original incident. There is no ticket of record.

This is the problem Halo was supposed to solve. Halo didn't. A 5-month POC and 100+ hours of Jim's time produced nothing usable.

WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING

One narrow product, built in public with Sibe.

Ticket core. SNYPR bridge. Email bridge. Customer portal.

That's it. Ship in 8 weeks.

No CRM. No quoting. No Salesforce replacement. No invoicing. The things Halo tried to do that weren't the job.

What's Actually Broken

Sibe, SOC manager, describes the workflow:

"We get so many emails, and it's hard to keep track of customer responding to it. We manually copy their response into SNYPR, say 'oh, customer responded this,' and keep manual track of: did the customer respond? If not, we've got to send them a manual email to follow up."

01

Email → SNYPR, manual.

Every customer response is hand-copied from soc@vdalabs.com into SNYPR. Dozens of copy-paste operations per day.

02

SNYPR → Email, manual.

When an analyst needs to notify a customer, they copy incident detail from SNYPR into a new email. Customer data mixed up across clients is a real, recurring incident.

03

No response tracking.

SLA clocks run in analysts' heads. Follow-ups are remembered, not triggered. Customers sometimes don't hear back.

Why Halo Failed

01

Sold as white-glove. Wasn't.

Halo promised 40 hours of professional services. Jim asked for 60. Over 5 months, he got 8 actual support hours. Everything else was homework.

02

Scope drifted into everything.

Started as ticketing. Grew into CRM + project management + quotes + invoicing. Adoption stalled across sales and project teams, and the rollout was reversed.

03

The implementation team vanished.

Two of the three Halo people left shortly after the sale. Jim was left to configure API endpoints alone, with no expertise in-house to decode errors when integrations broke.

04

100–200 hours, rolled back.

Jim's estimate of the configuration time he personally sunk into it. All of it reversible. None of it usable today.

Kendall calls this kind of build a 'science project.' That's the failure mode this plan is designed to prevent.

Design Principles

01 Design backward from Sibe's daily flow.

The MVP is successful if Sibe's copy-paste goes away. Everything else is secondary.

02 Analyst-initiated, not auto-everything.

Sibe doesn't want every SNYPR alert turning into a ticket. Analyst clicks a button in SNYPR; the ticket is created. Nothing else.

03 Keep sensitive data in SNYPR.

VDA sells "we don't store your data." The ticket references an incident ID back to SNYPR. It isn't a system of record for security telemetry.

04 Wrong-client leakage is a bug, not a risk.

Jim flagged this twice. The UI pulls customer context from the incident payload — so analysts can't paste one customer's data into another customer's email.

05 Ship in 8 weeks or the team stops believing.

Jim has been burned once. Kendall is watching. No scope creep, no scope negotiation, no Phase 2 features leaking into Phase 1.

Three Phases

PHASE 1

◆ RECOMMENDED

Ticketing MVP (8 weeks)

Ticket core + SNYPR bridge + email bridge + customer portal.

PROS

- What Jim asked for
- No scope creep
- Sibe's copy-paste goes away week 5

CONS

- Reporting and native apps are Phase 2

USE WHEN

When the daily pain is manual email ↔ SNYPR copy-paste.

PHASE 2

Reporting + Native Apps

Templated monthly client reports, the rest of Halo's requirements list, and native iOS/Android customer apps. Scoped after Phase 1 proves out.

PROS

- Addresses 'reports too basic' churn signal
- Differentiates vs. Huntress
- Customer app experience Kendall wants

CONS

- Only valuable once ticketing is adopted

USE WHEN

Once ticketing is proven and analysts trust it.

PHASE 3

Full Platform Replacement

Unified SecOps + ITSM + reporting. What Halo attempted.

PROS

- Highest long-term ceiling

CONS

- Same shape as Halo
- Same failure modes

USE WHEN

Not before 2027. Not before Phase 1 and Phase 2 prove out.

Recommendation

Start with Phase 1. Move to Phase 2 once ticketing is adopted. Do not commit to Phase 3 until 2027.

W H Y

The SOC team's daily pain is manual email copy-paste. The fix is one narrow product.

Solving it first earns the trust needed for the harder Phase 2 work — reports that compete with Huntress — and the eventual Phase 3 platform decision.

It's also the cheapest thing we can ship that moves a customer-visible metric in a quarter.

B U I L T A R O U N D K E N D A L L ' S C O N C E R N

- No big rollout. Two pilot customers, not 150.
- No six-month silence. Weekly check-ins in Slack.
- No resurrecting Halo. Different product, different scope.
- The Phase 2 reporting prototype shown is the ceiling, not the commitment. The deck commits only to Phase 1. Phase 2 is scoped and priced separately, only if ticketing proves out.
- Every phase has a kill switch.

If adoption drops below 70% at any checkpoint, we stop and diagnose before continuing.

Investment

\$15,000 - \$24,000 for the Phase 1 web app. Five weeks to first customer notification. Start: end of May.

PHASE 1 · \$15,000 - 24,000 · \$3,000 per week

Analyst ticketing app + customer portal, delivered as a web application. SNYPR bridge, email bridge, SLA tracking, wrong-client prevention.

Week 1 is a planning session: review this deck, walk a live incident with Sibe, confirm scope in writing. Build starts immediately after.

1–2 major revisions included. Target: 5 weeks. Buffer planned to 8.

TERMS

- 25% upfront (\$3,750), 75% on 5 or 8-week completion timeline (\$11,250/\$20,250).
- Milestones shared along the way so you see progress.
- Post-build: \$1,000/month for 5–8 hours of maintenance and support. Non-accruing.
- Overage beyond 8 hours billed at \$200/hr.

Phase 2 (reporting + native apps) is scoped and priced separately, after Phase 1 ships.

20-Week Roadmap

● W K 1 – 2	Discover + Plan	13-question discovery doc back from Jim + Sibe. Slack channel live. Sibe stands up a SOC dev account in Google Workspace. First walkthrough of a live incident in SNYPR.
● W K 3 – 5	MVP Ticketing	Ticket core. SNYPR SOAR playbook that creates tickets on analyst-initiated state change. Inbound bridge for soc@vdalabs.com. Wrong-client prevention. SLA clock per severity.
● W K 6 – 8	Pilot	Two pilot customers. Sibe + one other analyst live in the tool daily. Daily feedback in Slack. No new features — fix what breaks.
● W K 9 – 14	Reports — Phase 2 begins	Phase 2 scope confirmed and priced. Templated monthly reports begin. Ticketing rolls out to remaining 148 customers in batches.
● W K 15 – 20	Adopt	Named owner inside VDA. Weekly metric review. Playbooks and training built around real Phase 1 incidents. VDA's own engineers can extend the system.

MILESTONE · First customer notification sent from the tool in week 5. Full rollout complete by week 20.

How We Plan to Measure

MTTR

Mean time to resolution

Tracked per severity. Baseline captured weeks 1–2 by shadowing Sibe. Target set with him, not imposed.

SLA%

SLA adherence

Critical is a 1-hour SLA. Today: "most of the time."
Becomes a number. Customer response rate tracked alongside.

0

Copy-paste operations

Sibe's manual email ↔ SNYPR work. Today: dozens daily. Week 5 target: zero on pilots. Clearest MVP success signal.

ALSO TRACKED

Wrong-client incidents.

Baseline: multiple per quarter, per Jim. Week 5 target: zero.

Analyst adoption rate.

% of analysts using the tool for customer comms. 70% by week 8 or we stop.

Report depth signal.

Renewal conversations mentioning report quality. Logged by sales. Today: frequent. We watch it fall.

If Sibe's copy-paste count isn't zero by week 5 on the two pilot accounts, the system isn't working. Stop and diagnose.

What "good" looks like for VDA is a discovery question. The baselines come from sitting with the team in weeks 1–2 — not from this deck.

Next Steps

THIS WEEK

13-question discovery doc back from Jim + Sibe.

One page, quick answers. Questions cover alert sources, workflow states, SLAs, client actions, audit trail, out-of-scope, Halo landmines, success metrics.

THIS WEEK

Stand up the Slack channel.

Joey, Vincent, Jim, Sibe. Async feedback, quick check-ins, living spec. Replaces the scheduled-meeting cadence that killed Halo.

WEEK 1

Walk one live incident end-to-end with Sibe.

From the moment SNYPR fires an alert to the moment a customer replies. Document every click and copy-paste. This is the work we're eliminating.

WEEK 2

MVP scope locked in writing, signed by Kendall.

One page. No moving targets after this. Phase 2 features move to the Phase 2 doc.

The Technical Build

What the MVP actually looks like, what integrations are required, and what the Halo requirements list tells us we already have to support.

What We're Building

Jim's original Halo requirements list is our feature floor. Phase 1 delivers the narrow slice that removes the daily pain; Phase 2 delivers the rest.

PHASE 1 · THE 8-WEEK SCOPE

The 8-week scope.

- Ticket core: open, assign, note, status, close
- SNYPR SOAR playbook (analyst-initiated)
- Inbound email → ticket (soc@vдалabs.com)
- Tenancy: one customer per ticket, enforced
- Wrong-client prevention on compose
- SLA clock (severity-driven)
- Auto-reminders when customer doesn't reply
- Template-based outbound emails
- Customer portal (case, tickets, contract, docs)

PHASE 2 · REPORTING + NATIVE APPS

From Halo's requirements list.

- Templated monthly customer reports
- Native iOS + Android customer apps
- License usage tracking (S1, Huntress, SNYPR)
- Per-customer knowledge base
- Recurring tasks (weekly platform checks)
- CMDB for VDA internal devices
- API key expiration tracking
- Onboarding project templates (child tickets)

If Jim confirmed it with Halo, it's in scope somewhere. The question is only: Phase 1 or Phase 2?

How This Is Different From Halo

E1 Built around Sibe, not a vendor demo.

Sibe is in the tool from day one. Every screen is shaped against his daily workflow. Halo was shaped against a pitch deck.

E2 Analyst-initiated, by design.

Not every SNYPR alert becomes a ticket. The analyst decides. This matches how the SOC team already works instead of fighting it.

E3 Wrong-client leakage is a solved problem.

Customer context is pulled from the incident, not free-text. Outbound emails can't include data from another customer. The UI prevents it structurally.

E4 Email and SNYPR are both first-class inputs.

Every customer email to soc@vдалabs.com creates or updates a ticket. Every SNYPR playbook run creates a ticket. No manual copy-paste in either direction.

E5 No vendor lock-in.

React + Node.js on AWS, containerized and deployed with Terraform. Standard tooling, fully portable. VDA has operational control of the deployment and its data throughout. The tool doesn't die if we disappear. Commercial structure is flexible and shaped together.

None of this is technology Halo didn't have. It's the scope discipline Halo didn't have.

Technical Implementation

T1	Ticket Core	React + Node.js on AWS ECS. States: open, in-progress, awaiting-customer, resolved. Severity field drives SLA. Note: internal and external.
T2	SNYPR Bridge	Python playbook in SNYPR's built-in SOAR. Fires on analyst-initiated state change. POSTs incident payload (ID, severity, asset, customer) to our ticket API.
T3	Email Bridge	Inbound listener on soc@vdalabs.com. Subject parsing finds ticket ID; otherwise creates new ticket. Replies thread automatically.
T4	Customer Portal	Four views per Jim: open a case / view tickets / contract summary / documents. Magic-link auth. One account per customer, scoped by tenant. Design reference: Critical Start NDR's mobile customer app.
T5	SLA Clock	Runs per ticket by severity. Triggers automated customer follow-up if no response in X hours. Surfaces breaches to analyst queue.

Stack: React · Node.js · AWS (ECS / Docker) · Cloudflare · Terraform. VDA operates the deployment and controls its operational data from day one.